

Song Lab

Hear chords, build beats, and map your song. Scan the code or type:

cmfnyc.github.io/song-lab/



Mix & Export Checklist

Before you record

- ☐ Quiet room, soft surfaces (a closet full of clothes works great)
- ☐ Headphones on, so the music doesn't leak into the mic
- ☐ Mouth about one hand-width from the mic
- ☐ Warm up: hum, lip trills, sing the chorus once quietly
- ☐ Save a new version first (-v2 , -v3 ...)

Recording

- ☐ Record the chorus first (you know it best)
 - ☐ 3 takes per section, no stopping to judge
 - ☐ Listen back and keep the best take (or best phrases)
 - ☐ Optional: sing the chorus a second time on a new track (a "double") and pan the two slightly apart
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The four mix moves

1. Balance

- ☐ The **lead** (vocal or melody) is the loudest thing
- ☐ Drums next
- ☐ Everything else sits just under the lead
- ☐ Trick: turn everything down, then bring the lead up first, then add the others one at a time

2. Pan

- ☐ Center: kick, snare, bass, lead vocal
- ☐ Slightly left: chords (or one guitar)
- ☐ Slightly right: extra instrument (or second guitar)

3. Reverb

- ☐ A little reverb on the vocal so it sounds like it's in a room
- ☐ Too much = sounds far away. Back it off.

4. Headroom

- ☐ Nothing hits the red on the meters
 - ☐ If something does, turn that track down (not the whole song up)
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Level 2 mix moves (Song 2)

- ☐ **Muddy?** Turn down the bass/low end on everything except kick and bass
 - ☐ **Dull vocal?** Add a little treble
 - ☐ **Some words disappear?** Use a vocal preset with compression, or add a little more
 - ☐ **Low-volume test:** still balanced when very quiet? Then it's a good mix
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Check on more than one speaker

- ☐ Headphones
- ☐ iPad or phone speaker
- ☐ A car or a regular speaker, if you can

If the vocal disappears on the small speaker, turn it up.

Ending

- ☐ Ends on a big final chord, **or**

- ☐ Fades out over the last 2–4 bars (volume automation on the master track)
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Export

GarageBand on iPad

1. Go to **My Songs** (the song browser).
2. Press and hold your song → **Share**.
3. Choose **Song**, pick **Highest Quality**, add the title and your name as artist.
4. Save to Files or send it.

GarageBand on Mac

1. Menu: **Share** → **Export Song to Disk**.
2. Choose **AAC** or **MP3, Highest Quality**.
3. Name it `S1-[title]-FINAL`.

- ☐ Exported file saved
- ☐ GarageBand project saved separately (so you can remix later)
- ☐ Lead sheet made: melody PDF from おんぷノート, with chord names, lyrics, title, and your name added in Files → Markup